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Top Skills

FinTech
AI Governance
Data Strategies

Languages

Portuguese
English
Spanish

Certifications

Deep Learning Specialization
Time Series
Econometrics
R Programming
Computing for Data Analysis

Publications

Air transportation demand forecast through Bagging Holt Winters methods
Improving time series forecasting: An approach combining bootstrap aggregation, clusters and exponential smoothing
Improving time series forecasting: an approach combining Bootstrap Aggregation, Clusters and Exponential Smoothing
Forecasting the Air Transportation Demand: An application at Amsterdam Schiphol Airport using Bagged Holt Winters assisted by Compression-Based Dissimilarity measure
A Short Term Wind Speed Forecast: an application in the Brazilian Northeast

Tiago Dantas, PhD

Founder & CTO · PhD Data Scientist (M4 top-15 forecaster) | Data, AI & web3 leadership across fintech, gaming & the public sector | ex-Head of Data/CDO

Rio de Janeiro, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

Summary

I build the AI and fintech that survives a real P&L and after 19 years I can usually tell what's actually shipping from what's just staged. Most of what's sold as "AI" is a demo with good lighting. I'm interested in the part that isn't. I came to it as a scientist first. PhD in Industrial Engineering, a global top-15 finish at the M4 forecasting competition, and a method published in the International Journal of Forecasting — then put that rigor into real businesses, not papers. Some of what that's looked like: • As Head of Data / Chief Data Officer at a fintech, I built the data and AI function from one person to 18 and moved the numbers that justify it: +15% retention, -10% churn, +20% sales. • At Wildlife Studios, a Brazilian unicorn, I led 20+ data scientists and engineers across the US, Brazil, and Argentina, directing real-time prediction infrastructure at scale. • At IBGE, Brazil's national statistics bureau, I ran R&D and deployed the country's first web crawlers for the national inflation index — and represented Brazil at the UN Global Working Group on Big Data. When a whole country reads your number, you learn what "production" really means. • Today I'm CTO and partner running the technology and AI stack at one of Rio's largest operators, facial-recognition check-in, an AI call center, dynamic pricing, predictive maintenance, AI in production, not in a pitch. • I also co-founded HausBank, a fintech bridging traditional and decentralized finance (web3 as a credential, not a crusade). Underneath all of it: machine learning, data strategy, and the governance to know which AI decisions you can actually bet money on — and which belong on a risk register before they reach a board. I've also taught the methods (FGV, PUC-Rio, ENCE), which is mostly a test of whether you understand them. I work with a small number of founders, leadership teams, and boards on data and AI strategy, AI governance, and governed risk in fintech, as a fractional/advisory data leader, in senior Data & AI leadership, and on board and advisory seats. Based in Rio de Janeiro. Portuguese, English, Spanish.

Experience

Lobie

Partner & Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

March 2024 - Present (2 years 4 months)

- Operate Rio's largest short-stay business — thousands of units, one of Brazil's fastest-scaling — with AI at its core.
- Built the tech that scales operations without proportional headcount: facial-recognition check-in, AI 24/7 call center, dynamic pricing, predictive cleaning/maintenance.
- Turned a traditional real-estate operation into a company that scales like software.

HausBank

Co-Founder

2025 - Present (1 year)

- Co-founded a fintech bridging traditional and decentralized finance — banking, payments, and commission advances for real-estate brokers, developers, and operators.
- Subsidiary TokenHaus (VASP): RWA tokenization and cross-border crypto payments.
- Lead product strategy and technical architecture across the TradFi↔DeFi stack.

QStats

Founder

December 2015 - Present (10 years 7 months)

Rio de Janeiro

QStats is a consulting firm in Data Science and AI . Our approach usually combines cutting-edge AI/Machine Learning techniques with traditional Statistical Modeling.

The applications vary from generating highly accurate forecasts in fields like air transport, energy, insurance etc to discovering key patterns in Social Networks (e.g. Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, Spotify).

Wildlife Studios

Data Science Manager

December 2020 - March 2024 (3 years 4 months)

- Led a Diverse Team: Managed over 20 data scientists, engineers, analysts, and PMs across multiple countries, including the US, Brazil, and Argentina.
- Managed Multiple Teams: Oversaw teams in Pricing & Bidding, Creatives, Data Science Foundations, and Marketing Performance, ensuring alignment and efficiency across projects.
- Achieved Significant Growth: Grew our Adnets operation, resulting in a revenue and user acquisition increase of more than 25%.
- Developed Cutting-Edge Technology: Directed the development of the company's proprietary real-time ad-buying technology platform (DSP - Demand Side Platform), which processes over 25 million predictions per second. This platform competes in real-time ad tech auctions against major players like Google and Facebook.

Blu

Head of Data Science | Chief Data Officer (CDO)

January 2019 - December 2020 (2 years)

Rio de Janeiro, Rio de Janeiro

I was responsible for the data strategy of the company and founded BLU's data team which grew from 1 to 18 people (data scientists, data engineers, data analysts, interns, and managers). The team was responsible for everything related to data. Eg.:

- Designing the data infrastructure for Big Data analytics operations on the cloud that allowed to process and analyze millions of transactions in real time
- Developing Machine Learning algorithms to drive data-driven decision-making. This led to an increase in retention of more than 15%
- Predicting future outcomes and possible scenarios. This allowed to reduce churn in more than 10%
- Developing credit, lead, and other scores.
- Automating processes using algorithms. This reduced the burden of the commercial team allowing them to focus on selling. During this time commercial team increased sales in more than 20%

Fundação Getulio Vargas

Big Data and Data Science lecturer

October 2016 - March 2020 (3 years 6 months)

I helped create the "Big Data and Data Science" executive education course. This was one of the most successful courses during my time at FGV and led to several spin-offs such as the MBA in Data Science. I was also responsible for the following courses:

- Machine Learning
- Social Media

More details on <http://mgm-rio.fgv.br/cursos/big-data>

FGV is currently ranked as the #1 think tank in latin america according to Go To Think Tanks Index Report, published by the University of Pennsylvania

IBGE

9 years

Research And Development Manager

July 2015 - February 2019 (3 years 8 months)

Rio de Janeiro Area, Brazil

- Led the Research and Development team, comprising 8 PhDs/Masters holders in fields such as Statistics and Engineering. The team provided guidance on data science methods and techniques to all IBGE surveys, driving numerous innovations within the Institute.

- Responsibilities included statistical modeling and machine learning algorithms, time series analysis, web scraping, survey and sample design, data linkage, estimation, disclosure control, data editing, and imputation for missing data, among others.

- Pioneered the implementation of Big Data cutting-edge techniques and served as an evangelist for the topic. Appointed as IBGE's representative in the United Nations Global Working Group on Big Data for Official Statistics (<https://unstats.un.org/bigdata>).

- Led the innovation initiative by introducing web crawlers to collect data for the national inflation index, significantly enhancing the data collection process.

Statistician

March 2010 - July 2015 (5 years 5 months)

Rio de Janeiro, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

MAiS software de resultados

Data Science Mentor/Advisor

April 2018 - December 2018 (9 months)

Rio de Janeiro Area, Brazil

Mentored MaiS' data science team and acted as their Principal data scientist.

This team was acquired by Elo group.

Datos Technologies

Lead Data Scientist

February 2018 - December 2018 (11 months)

Greenville, South Carolina Area

Leading data science projects including: fraud detection, demand forecasting, price optimization and others. check: <https://datostechologies.com/team/>

Pontifícia Universidade Católica do Rio de Janeiro

Lecturer

April 2015 - June 2018 (3 years 3 months)

Creator and lecturer of the "Social Network Data analysis with R" extension course.

<http://www.cce.puc-rio.br/sitecce/website/website.dll/folder?nCurso=analise-de-dados-de-redes-sociais-utilizando-o-r&nInst=cce>

Escola Nacional de Ciências Estatísticas

Lecturer

March 2015 - August 2015 (6 months)

Rio de Janeiro Area, Brazil

Operations Research (Simulation methods, Queueing theory and Time Series) to undergraduate Students.

Escola Nacional de Ciências Estatísticas

Software Instructor

June 2012 - September 2013 (1 year 4 months)

Rio de Janeiro Area, Brazil

Software Instructor (SAS software) to students at Ms and Ph.D. level.

SAS / E-mining

Senior Analytical Consultant

November 2011 - March 2012 (5 months)

Rio de Janeiro Area, Brazil

Consultant for SAS at Petrobras (Strategy department):

- Responsible for developing Econometric and Time Series Models to Forecast important variables.

- Responsible for implementing the programs previously written in EVIEWS to SAS

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SulAmerica ING

Intern

September 2007 - August 2009 (2 years)

Intern at the Business Intelligence department.

Education

Pontifícia Universidade Católica do Rio de Janeiro

Doctor of Philosophy - PhD, Industrial Engineering · (August 2014 - July 2018)

Pontifícia Universidade Católica do Rio de Janeiro

Master of Science - MS, Electrical Engineering (time series forecasting) · (2009 - 2011)

Escola Nacional de Ciências Estatísticas

Bachelor of Science - BS, Statistics · (2005 - 2009)